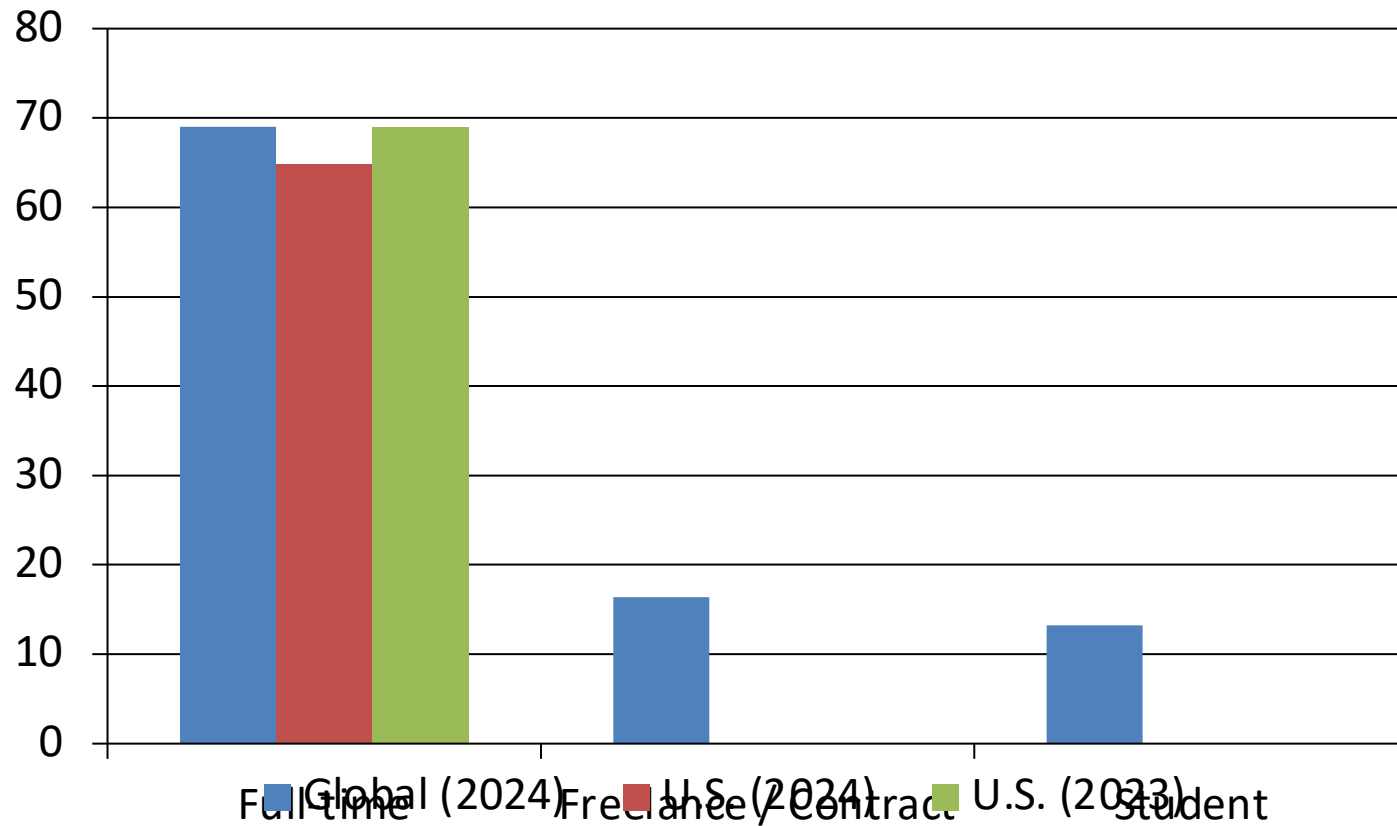


# **Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends — 2024 Stack Overflow Survey**

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: <https://survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work>

# 84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.



## Key Insights:

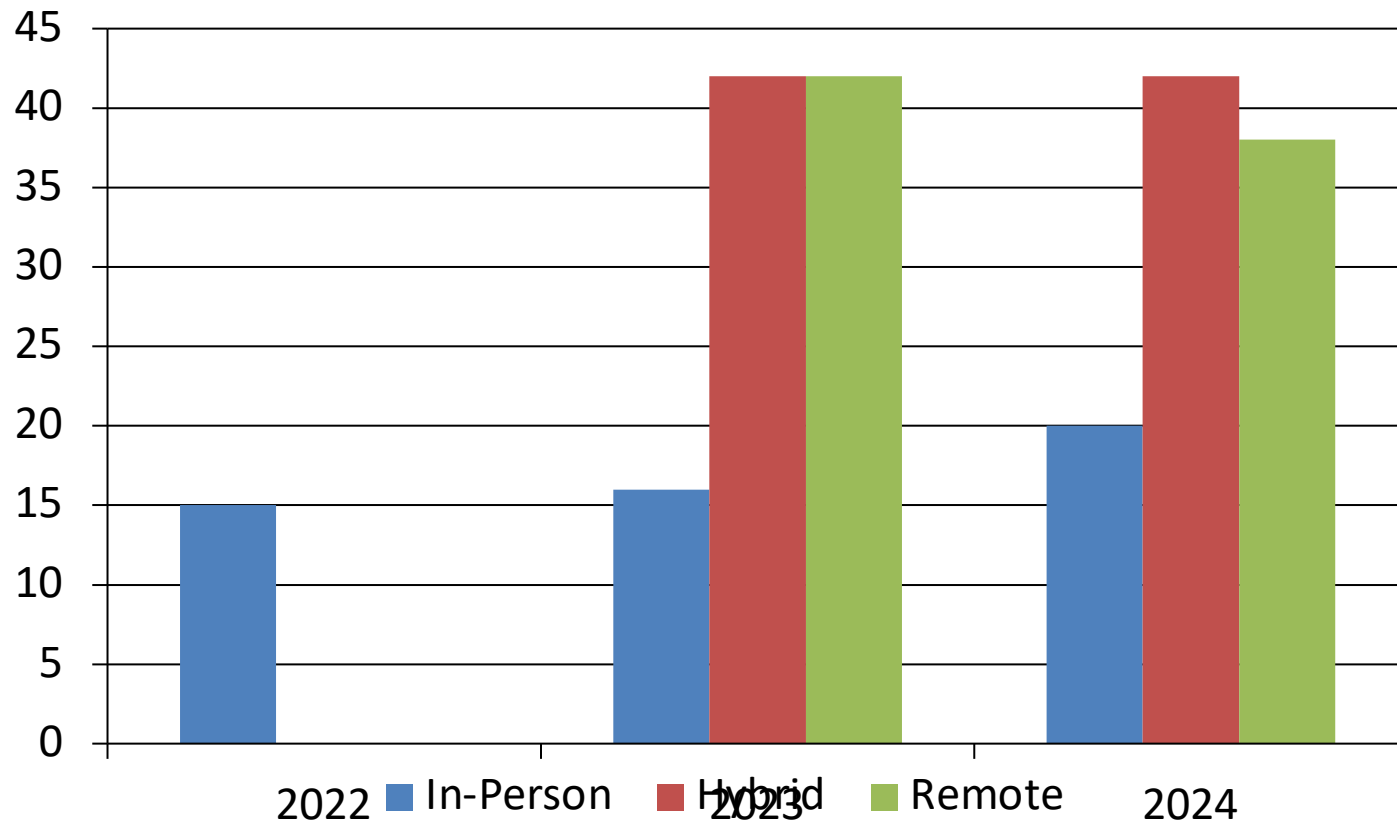
84% of respondents are currently working.

Full-time is dominant globally at 69%.

Independent contracting/freelancing accounts for 16.4%.

U.S. full-time employment dropped from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024.

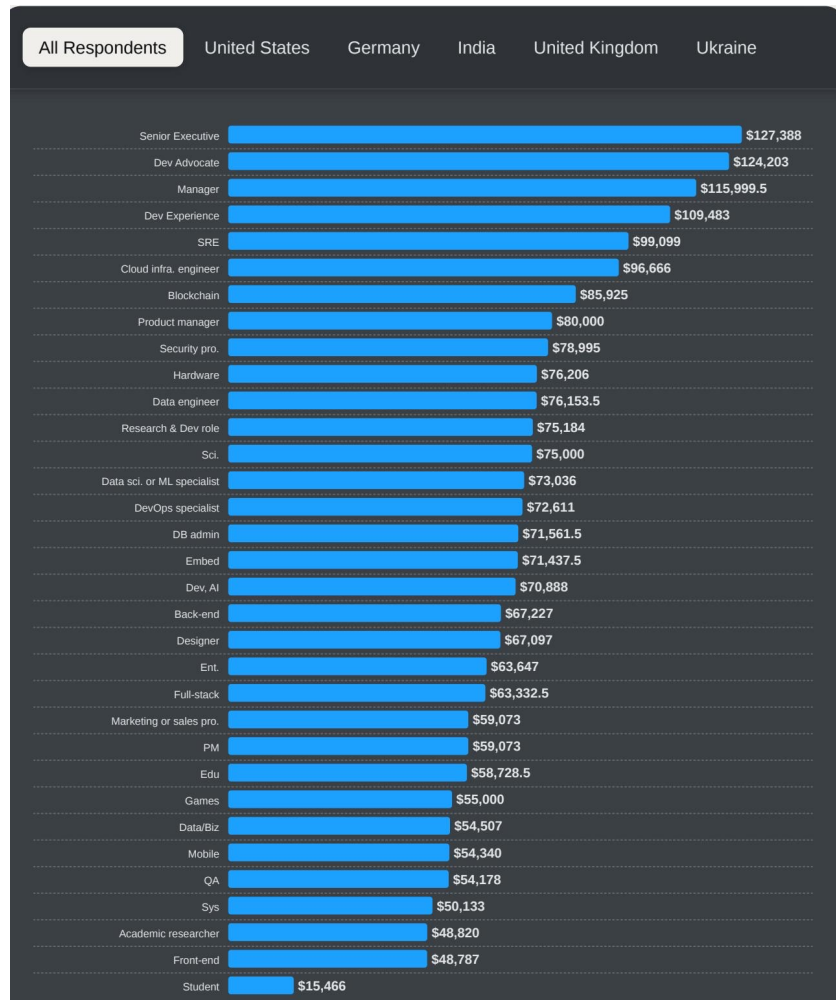
# In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



## Trend Analysis:

Hybrid work remains the most common arrangement at 42%, consistent with 2023. Remote work accounts for 38% of the workforce. In-person work has risen for the third consecutive year (from 15% to 20%). This signals a gradual return-to-office trend globally.

# Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



## Role Premiums:

Senior Executive: \$127,388 (~17 yrs exp)

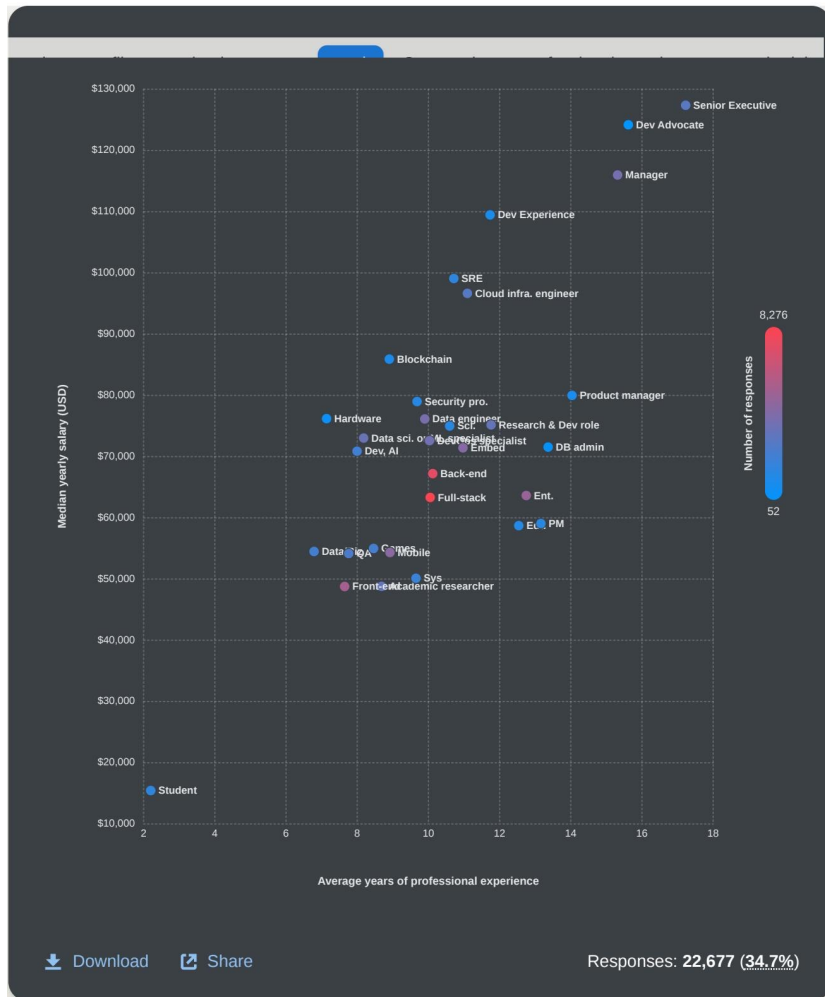
Dev Advocate: \$124,203 (~16 yrs exp)

Manager: \$115,999 (~15 yrs exp)

SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infra (\$97K) lead purely technical roles.

Front-end and Full-stack sit below the overall top tier.

# Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



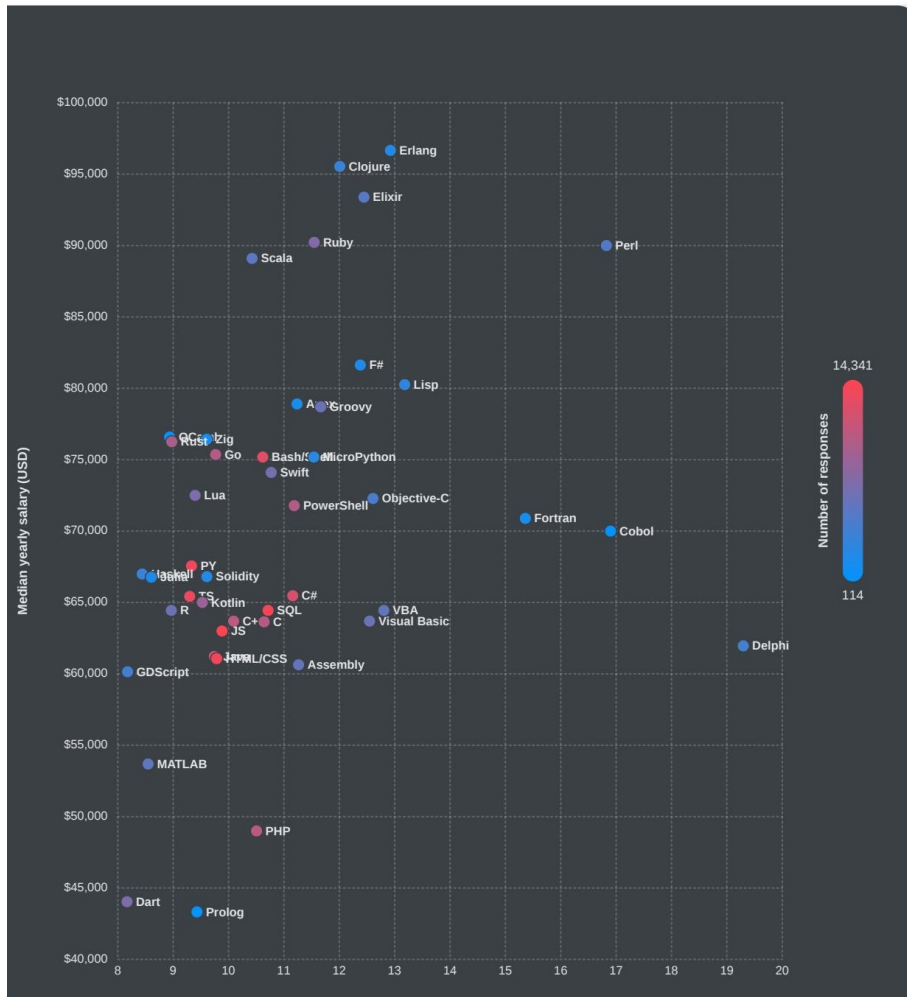
## Experience Correlates with Pay:

Clear cluster of senior roles in the upper-right (14+ years, \$100K+).

Student is an outlier at \$15K (~2 years).

Management and advocacy out-earn pure engineering at similar experience levels.

# Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



## Language Premiums:

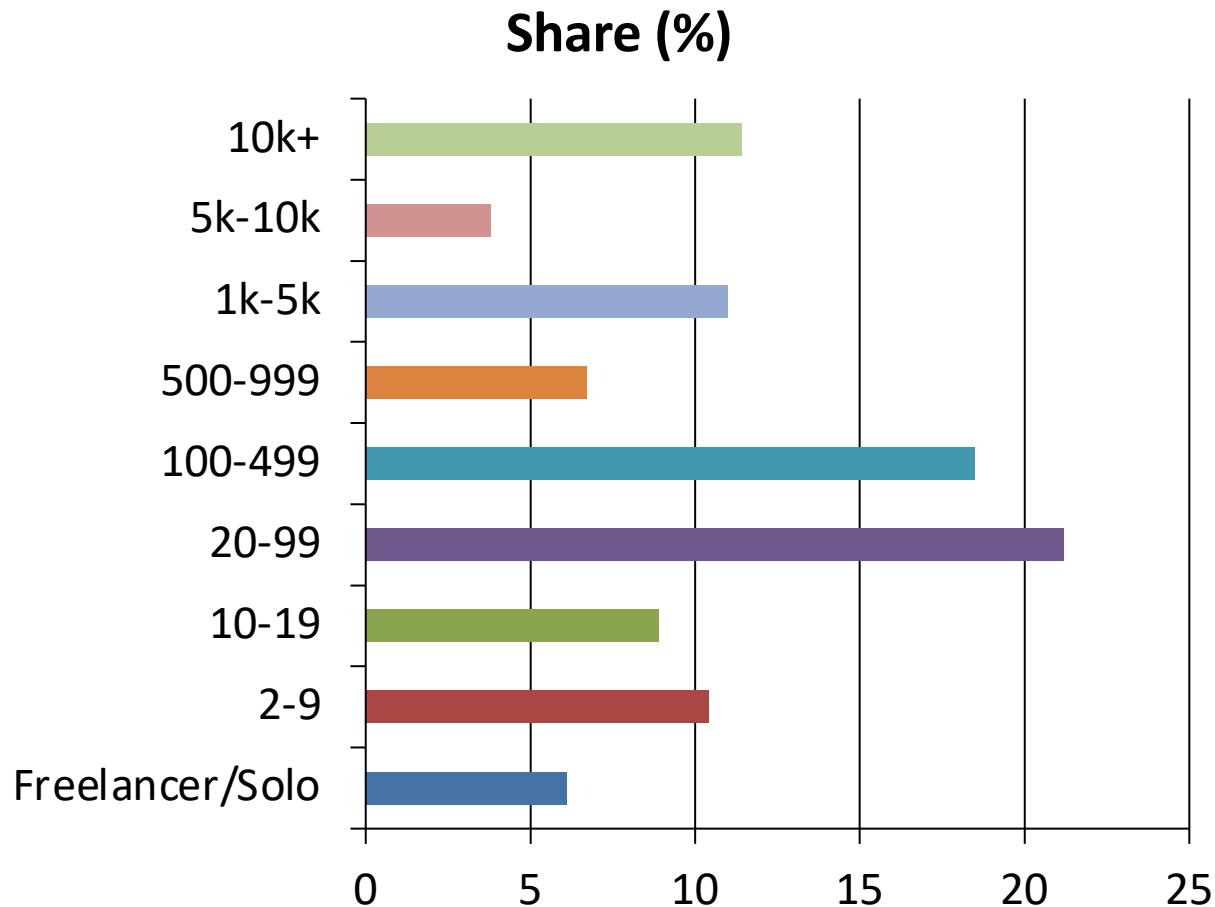
Niche functional languages earn the most.

Erlang (\$97K), Clojure (\$95K), Elixir (\$93K).

Mainstream languages (JS, Python) average \$64K–\$67K.

Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K compared to 2023.

# 47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



## Purchasing Influence:

62% of respondents influence technology purchases.

99% of Senior Executives and 87% of Engineering Managers wield influence.

77% of Product Managers influence purchases.

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach.

Top evaluation methods:

- Starting a free trial (75%)
- Asking other developers (73%)

# Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Full-time employment softening — U.S. full-time fell 4 points year-over-year. Plan for more contractors and freelancers.

In-person mandates growing but hybrid still dominant — In-person is up to 20%, but hybrid remains the norm at 42%.

DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay — Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and Managers (\$116K) top the charts.

Language choice correlates with pay — Niche functional languages pay significantly more than mainstream ones.

Most developers influence purchasing — With 62% having a say, vendor strategies must target individual contributors and not just management.